

The Hard Cases Manual

The nine walks that break the normal rules — each with the full four-page treatment: why it breaks them, the setup, the three-phase protocol, and the mistakes that cost a week.

MAKE IT STICK · FOR WHEN THE STREET CHEATS

01

The Off-Leash Charge

02

Hallways, Elevators & Stairwells

03

The Vet Visit

04

Night Walks & Low Visibility

05

The Multi-Dog Household Walk

06

Fence Fighters & Window Barkers

07

Car Reactivity

08

The Doorbell & Visitors

09

The Regression Week

How to use this manual

The 21-Day Plan handles the standard walk. This book handles everything that cheats — the situations where the normal rules bend, ration, or invert.

- ✓ **This is a reference, not a curriculum.** Nobody runs nine cases at once. Triage (next page) picks your two; the rest wait on the shelf until the street assigns them.
- ✓ **Every case assumes the Method's vocabulary** — zones, the number, the Loop, the U-turn, the bucket, 3-for-3. If those words aren't reflexes yet, finish the main plan first.
- ✓ **Four pages, one shape, every time:** the physics (why your good tools misfire here) → the setup (won before the first session) → the protocol (three phases, exact reps) → the pitfalls (mistakes + troubleshooting + a log strip).
- ✓ **One case at a time, two weeks per case** is the honest pace. Most cases are 70% setup and scheduling; the protocols themselves are short.
- ✓ **The safety page still rules everything.** Bites, kids, or fear inside your own home: credentialed professional, this week, with your logs in hand.

★ THE THEME, IF YOU WANT IT IN ONE LINE

Every hard case is the same lesson wearing different weather: **when you can't add distance, add time, barriers, or schedule — and when you can't add any of those, leave and bill it to management, not to your dog.**

Educational material; not veterinary or behaviorist advice. © CalmWalk.

Triage: which case, in which order

What's true at your house	Run this case	First move
Loose dogs keep materializing mid-walk	01 • The Off-Leash Charge	scan habit + the throw, today
We live in an apartment building	02 • Hallways & Elevators	recon week first; it's 80% timetable
Vet (or groomer) visit coming up	03 • The Vet Visit	book the quiet slot 3 days out
Walks only fit before dawn / after dark	04 • Night Walks	gear tonight, dusk-bridge tomorrow
There's a second (or third) dog at home	05 • The Multi-Dog Household	solo season starts now
He patrols windows / fights the fence	06 • Fence & Window	hardware store today — highest ROI in the book
The car ride is its own explosion	07 • Car Reactivity	containment + ledger before any drills
The doorbell detonates the house	08 • Doorbell & Visitors	bell station + gate this weekend
The numbers are climbing and I'm scared	09 • The Regression Week	two quiet days, then the audit

PICKING WHEN SEVERAL ARE TRUE

Order by **frequency, not drama**: the case that fires daily (windows, hallways, the household) outranks the scary one that fires monthly. Daily cases drain the bucket that monthly cases then overflow — fix the drip before the lightning. Exception: anything with a safety dimension (Case 1 in loose-dog country) installs its Phase 1 immediately regardless of order — the scan habit costs nothing.

Most households: Case 6 or 2 first (the daily rehearsal machines), then their situational case, with Case 9 read once now — before it's needed — like a fire exit.

CASE 01

The Off-Leash Charge

THE NIGHTMARE WITH A PROTOCOL · PAGE 1 OF 4 · THE PHYSICS

C1

WHY IT BREAKS THE NORMAL RULES

Every other situation in the Method assumes one beautiful fact: distance belongs to you. A charging off-leash dog deletes that fact at fifteen miles an hour. The zone map still exists — but somebody else is driving through it, and your dog knows it. That's why an off-leash encounter blows up dogs who were doing brilliantly: it isn't a failure of training; it's a different problem wearing the same fur.

So this case isn't trained on the sidewalk in the moment. It's trained like a fire drill: hands that move without thinking, a pouch that's always loaded, and a scan habit that buys you the only currency that matters here — seconds.

⚠ WHAT CHANGES VS THE STANDARD METHOD

Everything happens 5–10× faster, food stops being a measuring tool and becomes a projectile, and YOUR dog's behavior is the second priority — geometry (barriers, angles) is the first. The Loop is off-duty; the drill takes over.

Four-page treatment: physics → setup → the 3-phase protocol → mistakes & troubleshooting. Read all four before the first session; run them from page 3.

CASE 01

The Off-Leash Charge

THE NIGHTMARE WITH A PROTOCOL · PAGE 2 OF 4 · THE SETUP

C1

SETUP CHECKLIST — BEFORE THE FIRST SESSION

Fire drills are won at the equipment shelf, not the fire. Before the week starts:

- ✓ Pouch carries a **sacrifice handful**: 15–20 extra treats in one grabbable clump, every walk, no exceptions.
- ✓ Know your **throw**: practice underhand-scattering a fistful at a wall, twice, in the yard. (Yes, practice throwing food. Laugh, then do it.)
- ✓ Map the **loose-dog houses** on the Route Planner with dates — and trash day, when gates stand open.
- ✓ Pick your **barrier inventory** per route: which parked cars, hedges, gates, and porches can be put between dogs in under 5 seconds.
- ✓ Decide the **drop-the-leash rule** with your household NOW (contact imminent = drop), so nobody freezes deciding.
- ✓ Optional but strong: a pocket air-horn or compressed-air can for the genuinely scary repeat offender — and the animal-control number saved in your phone.

OUR LOOSE-DOG HOUSES (ADDRESS + LAST SEEN)

MY 3 FASTEST BARRIERS ON ROUTE A

CASE 01

The Off-Leash Charge

THE NIGHTMARE WITH A PROTOCOL · PAGE 3 OF 4 · THE PROTOCOL

C1

THE THREE-PHASE PROTOCOL

PHASE 1 · THE SCAN HABIT (DAYS 1-2)

EVERY
WALK

1. Walk your normal route narrating sight-lines: driveways, gaps, corners — half a second each, like a lifeguard's sweep.
2. At every loose-dog house: cross to the far side BEFORE the sight-line opens, automatically, forever.
3. Goal: the scan runs underneath conversation. It becomes how you walk.

PHASE 2 · THE DRY RUN (DAYS 3-5)

3 REPS × 3
DAYS

1. Empty street: shout your marker phrase — **"FOOD! GO ON!"** — throw the sacrifice handful AT an imaginary dog, feed YOUR dog's nose with the other hand, arc to the nearest barrier.
2. Time it. Under 6 seconds from shout to barrier = pass.
3. Rep 3 each day at a jog, with the leash in your weak hand.

PHASE 3 · THE LIVE LAYER (ONGOING)

AS THE WORLD
PROVIDES

1. First real encounter: run the drill exactly. Feed face → throw → barrier → deep **"SIT! GO HOME!"** if it keeps coming.
2. Afterward: straight home, Recovery Script, log the house, report repeat offenders (politely, in writing) — you are building a paper trail, not a feud.
3. Treat the next 48h as post-explosion even if your dog held it together. The bucket doesn't care how it looked.

CASE 01

The Off-Leash Charge

THE NIGHTMARE WITH A PROTOCOL · PAGE 4 OF 4 · THE PITFALLS

C1

THE CLASSIC MISTAKES

- ✗ Trying to run the Loop on an incoming dog — the Loop needs a stationary zone; this is a drill moment, not a training moment.
- ✗ Body-blocking face-to-face and backing up in a straight line — back-pedaling triggers chase; ARC sideways to barriers instead.
- ✗ Picking up a small reactive dog mid-charge as step one — lifting can escalate the incoming dog's jump; barrier first, lift behind it.
- ✗ Yelling at your own screaming dog while the other dog closes — spend the seconds on geometry, not discipline.
- ✗ Skipping the report because “nothing happened” — the third “nothing” is usually the something.

TROUBLESHOOTING

What's happening	What it usually is	What to do
The loose dog ignores thrown food	high-arousal or non-food dog	barrier + air-horn burst + command voice; food only buys time with normal pets
My dog redirects onto the leash/me	overflow with no exit	more distance EARLIER (the scan failed upstream); review days 1-2; consider a pro if it repeats
Same dog charges weekly	management problem, not training problem	route around the block entirely + written complaint; you can't train someone else's dog
I froze completely	no rehearsed first move	re-run Phase 2 for three days; the drill exists to replace thinking

CASE LOG

Date	Phase	What we ran	Result (1-5)

CASE 02

Hallways, Elevators & Stairwells

REACTIVITY WHERE DISTANCE IS RATIONED · PAGE 1 OF 4 · THE PHYSICS

C2

WHY IT BREAKS THE NORMAL RULES

The Method's first law is “add distance,” and an apartment corridor laughs at it: eight feet wide, blind doors every few yards, and an elevator that is, functionally, a closing trap with carpet. Buildings break the zone map — so building work swaps distance for its three substitutes: **time** (when you move), **barriers** (what's between you), and **thresholds** (who commits to shared space first).

The good news: buildings are scheduled creatures. The 7:40 shepherd, the 6pm doodle rush — the same dozen dogs on the same dozen timers. Nowhere is recon more profitable.

★ WHAT CHANGES VS THE STANDARD METHOD

You will often work at distances that would be deep yellow outdoors. The fix is duration: exposures last 2–5 seconds (a door pass) instead of a 90-second session. Short + managed beats far + impossible.

Four-page treatment: physics → setup → the 3-phase protocol → mistakes & troubleshooting. Read all four before the first session; run them from page 3.

CASE 02

Hallways, Elevators & Stairwells

REACTIVITY WHERE DISTANCE IS RATIONED · PAGE 2 OF 4 · THE SETUP

C2

SETUP CHECKLIST — BEFORE THE FIRST SESSION

One week of recon converts a hostile building into a known one:

- ✓ Write the **building dog timetable**: who, where, when, for 5 days. (The mailbox run counts as recon.)
- ✓ Map **pressure-release spots** per floor: alcoves, stair doors, the trash room — anywhere a dog-width off the main line.
- ✓ Claim a **scan ritual** at every door: crack, look, listen, THEN commit. Three seconds, every time, forever.
- ✓ Pick your **stair policy**: which floors you'll simply walk. Two flights = a city block of separation.
- ✓ Pre-load the **mat station** by your own door: a mat 6 ft inside, where the dog waits while you scan the hallway.
- ✓ Brief the household: nobody opens the door dog-first. Ever.

OUR BUILDING'S DOG TIMETABLE (NAME · PLACE · TIME)

PRESSURE-RELEASE SPOTS PER FLOOR

CASE 02

Hallways, Elevators & Stairwells

REACTIVITY WHERE DISTANCE IS RATIONED · PAGE 3 OF 4 · THE PROTOCOL

C2

THE THREE-PHASE PROTOCOL

PHASE 1 · OWN YOUR DOORWAY (DAYS 1-3)

5 MIN ×
2/DAY

1. Drill the exit: dog waits on the mat → you crack the door and scan → “YES” for holding the wait → release through together on a loose leash.
2. 10 reps a session; vary how long the scan takes so the wait is real.
3. Re-enter the same way. The doorway becomes a checkpoint, not a launch ramp.

PHASE 2 · CORRIDOR REPS (DAYS 4-7)

OFF-PEAK
ONLY

1. At dead hours, walk the corridor doing 2-3 second “door passes”: approach a closed door, pause a body-length off, YES + pay for a soft glance, move on.
2. Add the stairwell: one flight down, pause on the landing, listen, proceed. Pay quiet landings.
3. If a neighbor dog appears: pressure-release spot, finder scatter on the floor, let them pass. That IS the rep.

PHASE 3 · THE ELEVATOR PROTOCOL (WEEK 2)

GRADUATED

1. Empty-car reps first: board, rear corner, you between dog and door, scatter 2-3 treats, ride one floor, exit. 5 reps.
2. Then occupied-by-humans reps. Dogs? **Skip the car. Always. Forever.** “We’ll catch the next one” is the single highest-value sentence in apartment dog ownership.
3. Long-term: the corner position becomes automatic; most dogs start defaulting into it by week 3.

CASE 02

Hallways, Elevators & Stairwells

REACTIVITY WHERE DISTANCE IS RATIONED · PAGE 4 OF 4 · THE PITFALLS

C2

THE CLASSIC MISTAKES

- ✗ Treating the hallway like a sidewalk and trying to run full Loops in it — corridors are for passage management, not training sessions.
- ✗ Letting the dog exit the apartment first — the door commits you before the scan happens.
- ✗ Sharing an elevator with another dog “because it was awkward to refuse” — awkward beats explosive; skip the car.
- ✗ Punishing hallway barking — corridor acoustics make one woof feel catastrophic; manage geometry, run the Recovery Script, move on.
- ✗ Skipping recon because “it’s just my building” — the timetable is 80% of this case.

TROUBLESHOOTING

What's happening	What it usually is	What to do
Door-dash the moment the latch clicks	no doorway ritual installed	Phase 1 for a full week; feed the wait position 20×/day (it's free)
Explodes at door sounds inside the unit	hypervigilance at home (window/door soundtrack)	white-noise machine by the door + mat station farther inside; case 6's sound plan transfers
Neighbor insists their dog 'just wants to say hi'	humans, untrainable as ever	“He's in training, we need the space — thanks!” while moving; repeat verbatim; you owe no seminar
Stairwell is the trigger (echoes, surprise turns)	acoustic startle stacking	pay every landing pause; descend at off-hours for a week before normal hours

CASE LOG

Date	Phase	What we ran	Result (1-5)

CASE 03

The Vet Visit

THE APPOINTMENT THAT TAXES A WEEK · PAGE 1 OF 4 · THE PHYSICS

C3

WHY IT BREAKS THE NORMAL RULES

The vet trip stacks every drip the bucket knows: the car, the lobby of strangers, other animals' alarm-smells, handling by people with gloves, and pain or its memory — all in ninety minutes. Most reactive dogs spend the next two or three days over a half-full bucket, and owners who don't see that coming read the regression as mystery backsliding.

You cannot Loop your way through a vaccine. The goals here are different: spend as little bucket as possible on logistics, bank the appointment, and pre-pay the recovery.

WHAT CHANGES VS THE STANDARD METHOD

This is a containment-and-recovery case, not a desensitization case. You're not training in the lobby; you're getting through it cheaply. (True vet-fear retraining — 'happy visits' — is a worthy add-on once the basics hold.)

Four-page treatment: physics → setup → the 3-phase protocol → mistakes & troubleshooting. Read all four before the first session; run them from page 3.

CASE 03

The Vet Visit

THE APPOINTMENT THAT TAXES A WEEK · PAGE 2 OF 4 · THE SETUP

C3

SETUP CHECKLIST — BEFORE THE FIRST SESSION

Almost the whole case is won by phone, three days early:

- ✓ Book the **first slot of the morning** or the one right after lunch — the empty-lobby slots.
- ✓ Ask for **car check-in**: “can you text us when the room is ready? He's reactive and we'll wait in the car.” Clinics say yes constantly.
- ✓ Request a **side-door or straight-to-room entry** if the lobby is unavoidable.
- ✓ Pack the **vet kit**: spray cheese or a lick-mat smeared with something glorious, the mat from home, and 2× normal treat load.
- ✓ Schedule **NOTHING** for the dog for 48h after — the calendar block IS the protocol.
- ✓ If your dog has ever needed muzzling there: muzzle-train at home **FIRST** (FE p. 65) so the clinic muzzle isn't the first muzzle.

CLINIC'S QUIET SLOTS / WHO I SPOKE TO

OUR VET-KIT CHECKLIST

CASE 03

The Vet Visit

THE APPOINTMENT THAT TAXES A WEEK · PAGE 3 OF 4 · THE PROTOCOL

C3

THE THREE-PHASE PROTOCOL

PHASE 1 · THE WEEK BEFORE

10
MIN/DAY

1. Run 3–4 car-cooperation reps if the car is hard (see Case 7's Phase 1 — it transfers whole).
2. Twice, drive TO the clinic parking lot, scatter a finder in the grass strip, drive home. The lot stops predicting doom.
3. Keep the rest of the week deliberately boring: you want an empty bucket at the door.

PHASE 2 · GAME DAY

THE
SCRIPT

1. Sniffy 10-minute walk before loading; arrive at the quiet slot; **wait in the car** until texted.
2. Lobby (if forced): corner seat, dog's mat on the floor, lick-mat deployed, your body as a screen. Other animal enters? You and the dog step OUTSIDE; reception understands and keeps your place.
3. In the room: continuous lick-mat during handling; brief the staff that long fast greetings, not slow ones, set him off (or whatever YOUR inventory says — you have the data; clinics love being briefed).
4. Exit through the same quiet route. Pay the parking-lot grass one more time.

PHASE 3 · THE 48-HOUR INVOICE

2
DAYS

1. Day after: full Quiet Day, indoor enrichment, no agenda.
2. Day two: re-measure before any work; expect +1–2 cars; honor it without commentary.
3. Log the visit in the diary with a bucket-5 mark so future-you understands that week's wave.

CASE 03

The Vet Visit

THE APPOINTMENT THAT TAXES A WEEK · PAGE 4 OF 4 · THE PITFALLS

C3

THE CLASSIC MISTAKES

- ✗ Booking the 5:30pm Friday slot — the lobby at rush hour is a trigger convention.
- ✗ “He has to learn to handle the lobby” — no, he has to get vaccinated; learning happens on your schedule, not the clinic's.
- ✗ Forgetting the visit when the week's numbers wobble — the invoice always arrives; label it.
- ✗ Letting lobby strangers and their dogs “say hi to help him” — the Exposure Trap in scrubs.
- ✗ Trying first-ever muzzling, nail trims, AND vaccines in one heroic visit — split the bills.

TROUBLESHOOTING

What's happening	What it usually is	What to do
Trembles at the parking lot before we even park	the lot itself is a loaded trigger	double the Phase-1 lot-picnic reps; ask about gabapentin-style pre-visit support — that's a VET conversation, and a good one
Fine at the vet, explodes for 3 days after	delayed bucket overflow	extend the invoice: 72h quiet, then re-measure; some dogs bill slowly
Clinic won't do car check-in	policy or chaos	wait outside the door instead of the lobby; or honestly: shop clinics — fear-free-certified practices exist and advertise it
Muzzle panic at the clinic	muzzle = clinic = needles association	home muzzle program (FE p. 65) for 2 weeks until it predicts peanut butter, not procedures

CASE LOG

Date	Phase	What we ran	Result (1-5)

CASE 04 Night Walks & Low Visibility

WHEN NEITHER OF YOU CAN SEE THE TRIGGER COMING · PAGE 1 OF 4
· THE PHYSICS

C4

WHY IT BREAKS THE NORMAL RULES

Darkness halves your scanning range and your dog's — but not his hearing or nose. So at night the trigger announces itself as a jingle, a shadow, a shape that resolves too late: every encounter is an ambush by default. Dogs who are 6-car dogs at noon are often 9-car dogs at night, and dogs with any startle wiring are at their worst.

Night work, therefore, is ambush work: wider defaults, brighter gear, and routes chosen for sight-lines rather than scenery. (If you've been walking at 5am to avoid the world, this case is also your roadmap back toward daylight — on purpose, not by exile.)

★ WHAT CHANGES VS THE STANDARD METHOD

Add a standing **night surcharge of +2 to +3 cars** to every number, treat every corner as blind (because it is), and move the real training sessions to daylight — night walks are for maintenance, not laddering.

Four-page treatment: physics → setup → the 3-phase protocol → mistakes & troubleshooting. Read all four before the first session; run them from page 3.

CASE 04

Night Walks & Low Visibility

WHEN NEITHER OF YOU CAN SEE THE TRIGGER COMING · PAGE 2 OF 4
· THE SETUP

C4

SETUP CHECKLIST — BEFORE THE FIRST SESSION

Night work is mostly a gear and routing problem:

- ✓ **Light yourself and the dog:** a clip light on the harness (red = gentler), a headlamp or chest light for you — to see AND be seen by other handlers early.
- ✓ **Reflective everything:** leash, harness straps, your jacket cuffs (your hands gesture the U-turn).
- ✓ **Re-route for lit, wide, open streets** — the pretty dark shortcut is a liability; boring and bright wins.
- ✓ **Choose corner protocol:** every corner taken WIDE, to the curb edge, scanning as the sight-line opens.
- ✓ **Load the pouch by the door, under light** — fumbling for treats in the dark mid-ambush is a clown show.
- ✓ **Learn your night soundscape** on one dog-free recon lap: which yards jingle, which AC units mask approach noise.

OUR LIT ROUTE (STREETS, IN ORDER)

JINGLE YARDS / MASKED CORNERS TO TAKE WIDE

CASE 04

Night Walks & Low Visibility

WHEN NEITHER OF YOU CAN SEE THE TRIGGER COMING · PAGE 3 OF 4
· THE PROTOCOL

C4

THE THREE-PHASE PROTOCOL

PHASE 1 · DUSK BRIDGE (NIGHTS 1-3)

15
MIN

1. Walk the chosen lit route at DUSK — half-light, half-traffic — with the +2 surcharge active.
2. Drill 5 U-turns per walk in the dark-adjacent conditions; the cue must work when he can barely see your body turn (voice carries the load).
3. Pay every calm corner-wide maneuver.

PHASE 2 · TRUE NIGHT (NIGHTS 4-7)

15
MIN

1. Full dark, same route, surcharge +3. Loops only on triggers you can identify EARLY under lights.
2. Anything that resolves late (shape, jingle, shadow): automatic U-turn, no diagnostics. At night, ambiguity = yellow.
3. Finder scatters under streetlights work beautifully; grass is grass at any hour.

PHASE 3 · THE DAYLIGHT MIGRATION (WEEKS 2-4)

GRADUAL

1. If night walking was avoidance, start the walk 15 minutes earlier every 3-4 days, riding the ladder's gains back toward civilization.
2. Keep one night slot weekly as a skill-maintenance walk — calm darkness is a skill worth keeping.
3. Log night numbers separately; watching the night-surcharge shrink is its own satisfying graph.

CASE 04

Night Walks & Low Visibility

WHEN NEITHER OF YOU CAN SEE THE TRIGGER COMING · PAGE 4 OF 4
· THE PITFALLS

C4

THE CLASSIC MISTAKES

- ✗ Retractable leash at night — bad at noon, unforgivable in the dark.
- ✗ Laddering distance at night — you can't read mouths and micro-signals you can't see; ladders are a daylight sport.
- ✗ Headphones / podcast walking — you just gave away the only sense the dark didn't take.
- ✗ The unlit greenbelt shortcut “because it's empty” — it's not empty; you just can't see who's in it.
- ✗ Treating a night explosion as a training failure — it was an ambush; the answer is more surcharge and wider corners, not more reps.

TROUBLESHOOTING

What's happening	What it usually is	What to do
Startles at shadows/bags/bins at night only	low-light shape ambiguity (normal canine vision)	pay every voluntary investigate-and-disengage of an object; don't force approaches to 'show him'
Other walkers appear silently from nowhere	their stealth, your masked corners	your light sweep announces YOU; take masked corners at full width with a pre-emptive arc
Night number won't shrink	you're laddering in the dark	stop; ladder at dawn/day, maintain at night; the night gap closes from the daylight side
He's MORE alert at night at home after walks	arousal, not tiredness, from ambush walking	shorten night walks, lengthen the post-walk sniff segment and indoor wind-down

CASE LOG

Date	Phase	What we ran	Result (1-5)

CASE 05

The Multi-Dog Household Walk

ONE LEASH PER HAND IS ONE DOG TOO MANY · PAGE 1 OF 4 · THE PHYSICS

C5

WHY IT BREAKS THE NORMAL RULES

Two dogs do not walk as two separate dogs. They walk as a system: arousal travels down the leash, across to the other leash, and back, amplified. The steady dog teaches the reactive one nothing by proximity — but the reactive one teaches the steady one plenty, because alarm barking is the most contagious behavior dogs own. One explosion a week, in stereo, and you'll soon have a matched set.

The rule of this case is brutal and liberating: **the reactive dog trains alone**. The pack walk is a separate product, re-introduced only after the solo work holds — and even then, as a managed formation, not a tangle of romance and retractables.

△ WHAT CHANGES VS THE STANDARD METHOD

Nothing about the Method changes — it just runs SOLO. What's added is a household logistics layer (who walks whom, when) and a formal re-merger protocol with pass gates.

Four-page treatment: physics → setup → the 3-phase protocol → mistakes & troubleshooting. Read all four before the first session; run them from page 3.

CASE 05

The Multi-Dog Household Walk

ONE LEASH PER HAND IS ONE DOG TOO MANY · PAGE 2 OF 4 · THE SETUP

C5

SETUP CHECKLIST — BEFORE THE FIRST SESSION

This case is won on the family calendar before it's won on the street:

- ✓ Split the roster: **reactive dog walks solo** for the full 21-day plan. Non-negotiable.
- ✓ The other dog(s) get their own walks or yard sessions — guilt about this is normal and misplaced; they're getting MORE attention, not less.
- ✓ One handler per dog for the eventual pack walk; if you're a one-human household, the pack walk waits longer. That's fine.
- ✓ Decide the **formation** now: steady dog curbside, reactive dog inside (away from passing triggers), handlers shoulder to shoulder.
- ✓ Separate gear hooks: the solo-walk kit (pouch, cards, leash) must be grabbable without untangling the pack kit.
- ✓ Indoors: feed the calm. Whenever one dog watches the other get worked/fed and stays quiet — pay THAT dog. The audience skill is trainable.

WHO WALKS WHOM, WHEN (THE ACTUAL SCHEDULE)

CASE 05

The Multi-Dog Household Walk

ONE LEASH PER HAND IS ONE DOG TOO MANY · PAGE 3 OF 4 · THE PROTOCOL

C5

THE THREE-PHASE PROTOCOL

PHASE 1 · SOLO SEASON (WEEKS 1-3)

THE FULL PLAN

1. Run the entire 21-day plan with the reactive dog alone. Everything else waits for this.
2. Meanwhile, audit the steady dog honestly on one solo walk: is she actually steady, or just quieter? Two reactive dogs = two solo programs.
3. Indoors, run the audience drill daily: one dog does 5 easy reps, the other is paid for spectating calmly. Swap.

PHASE 2 · THE RE-MERGER (WEEK 4)

3 GATED WALKS

1. Walk 1: two handlers, dogs in formation, Route B (the bunker), 10 minutes, zero triggers sought. Pass = loose leashes throughout.
2. Walk 2: Route A at the quiet hour, formation held, ONE planned green-zone pass of a trigger. The reactive dog's handler runs the Loop; the steady dog's handler just keeps walking.
3. Walk 3: normal hour, normal length. Pass = the reactive dog's number with company within +1 of solo. If any gate fails: one more week of solo, retry. No shame, no rush.

PHASE 3 · PACK MAINTENANCE (FOREVER)

WEEKLY

1. Keep one solo session per week for the reactive dog — the ladder lives there.
2. On pack walks, the formation IS the rule: positions fixed, the reactive dog never on the trigger side.
3. Any pack-walk explosion: next two walks are solo again. The system resets cheap if you reset it fast.

CASE 05

The Multi-Dog Household Walk

ONE LEASH PER HAND IS ONE DOG TOO MANY · PAGE 4 OF 4 · THE PITFALLS

C5

THE CLASSIC MISTAKES

- ✗ “The calm one will teach him” — the most expensive sentence in multi-dog ownership; contagion runs the other way.
- ✗ Coupler leashes on a reactive dog — you’ve hard-wired the arousal circuit dog-to-dog.
- ✗ One human, two leashes, one reactive dog — you cannot Loop, U-turn, scatter, AND manage a second animal; physics says no.
- ✗ Letting the dogs greet every passing trigger together “since there are two of them” — stereo flooding.
- ✗ Skipping the steady-dog audit — half of “my other dog is fine” dogs are quietly yellow.

TROUBLESHOOTING

What's happening	What it usually is	What to do
Reactive dog screams when the other leaves for a walk	frustration + FOMO at the door	feed a frozen lick-mat in the crate/room AS the door closes, every time; it fades in days
Steady dog now barks at triggers too	contagion already priced in	solo walks for BOTH; run the steady dog through week 1 of the plan as a checkup
Formation collapses mid-walk (crossing, tangling)	positions never drilled dog-free	two humans, zero dogs, one rehearsal walk (yes really); then re-add dogs
They're perfect together, awful apart	social buffering masking the solo deficit	more solo season; the buffer is real but it isn't skill — build the skill, keep the buffer as a bonus

CASE LOG

Date	Phase	What we ran	Result (1–5)

CASE 06

Fence Fighters & Window Barkers

THE HOME REHEARSAL MACHINE · PAGE 1 OF 4 · THE PHYSICS

C6

WHY IT BREAKS THE NORMAL RULES

You can run a flawless 21-day plan outdoors and watch it stall — because back home, the living-room window runs an explosion gym eight hours a day. Window and fence barking is **self-rewarding rehearsal**: dog barks, mail carrier leaves (they were always leaving), dog's brain banks a win. Dozens of successful reps a day, every day, against your sixteen minutes. The ladder never had a chance.

This case is also the multiplier case: fix it and your street numbers often improve on their own, because the all-day bucket drip stops. It is the highest-ROI homework in this manual.

★ WHAT CHANGES VS THE STANDARD METHOD

The order inverts: **block first, train second**. Outdoors we find distance; at home we manufacture it with film, furniture, and schedules — THEN counter-condition the sounds that remain.

Four-page treatment: physics → setup → the 3-phase protocol → mistakes & troubleshooting. Read all four before the first session; run them from page 3.

CASE 06

Fence Fighters & Window Barkers

THE HOME REHEARSAL MACHINE · PAGE 2 OF 4 · THE SETUP

C6

SETUP CHECKLIST — BEFORE THE FIRST SESSION

Day one is a hardware-store day, and it does most of the work:

- ✓ **Window film** (frosted static-cling, \$15) on the bottom half of the trigger windows. Light comes in; the show gets cancelled.
- ✓ Move the **furniture launchpad**: the sofa back / cat tree / bench he patrols from gets 90 days away from the glass.
- ✓ **Fence audit**: board the gap he fights through, or run a second visual barrier (reed screen) along the hot section.
- ✓ **White noise / radio** near the door and window during peak delivery hours.
- ✓ Chart the **patrol schedule**: when do the explosions actually happen? (It's usually 4 predictable windows a day.)
- ✓ Build the **observation post**: a mat AWAY from the glass with a sight-line to YOU, not the street.

OUR TRIGGER WINDOWS / FENCE HOT ZONES

THE DAILY EXPLOSION WINDOWS (TIMES)

CASE 06

Fence Fighters & Window Barkers

THE HOME REHEARSAL MACHINE · PAGE 3 OF 4 · THE PROTOCOL

C6

THE THREE-PHASE PROTOCOL

PHASE 1 · SHUT DOWN THE GYM (DAYS 1-3)

HARDWARE

1. Film up, furniture moved, fence boarded, noise on. Expect protest patrols for 48h; hold the line.
2. Yard time becomes SUPERVISED-ONLY for two weeks. An unattended yard with a fence-fight running is a rehearsal studio.
3. Do nothing else yet. Blocking alone typically cuts daily explosions 60-80%.

PHASE 2 · PAY THE SOUNDS (DAYS 4-10)

10 REPS ×
3/DAY

1. The sounds remain (footsteps, truck brakes, the neighbor dog's tags). New game: sound happens → you say nothing → the INSTANT he orients without barking, "YES" + treat tossed AWAY from the window.
2. Too slow? He barked? No drama: walk to the kitchen; the game pays silence only.
3. Run it during the charted explosion windows on purpose — that's when the reps come pre-scheduled.

PHASE 3 · THE PROFESSIONAL SPECTATOR (WEEKS 2-4)

ONGOING

1. Teach mat-by-default: every delivery-hour, pre-load the observation post with a chew/lick-mat. He learns the 11am truck predicts mat magic, not patrol duty.
2. Peel back management slowly: clear the top half of one window at week 3; if quiet holds 3 days, continue. Any relapse: re-film, no commentary.
3. Fence: supervised yard sessions where the neighbor dog's noises get the Phase-2 game, from the patio, at maximum yard distance.

CASE 06

Fence Fighters & Window Barkers

THE HOME REHEARSAL MACHINE · PAGE 4 OF 4 · THE PITFALLS

C6

THE CLASSIC MISTAKES

- ✗ Training first, blocking later — you cannot out-treat an 8-hour-a-day rehearsal schedule.
- ✗ Yelling from the kitchen — congratulations, you've joined the barking; the pack alarm is now official.
- ✗ Removing ALL window access forever — the goal is a dog who can see the street and shrug; film is scaffolding, not architecture.
- ✗ Letting the dogs “work it out” through the fence — fence-fighting is mutual flooding with property damage.
- ✗ Counting indoor explosions as “not real walks” in the log — the bucket doesn't itemize; log them.

TROUBLESHOOTING

What's happening	What it usually is	What to do
Barks at sounds with all visuals blocked	auditory-led barker	more Phase 2, plus white noise during peak hours; sound games work, they're just slower than visual blocks
Neighbor dog initiates the fence fights	their rehearsal schedule, not yours	double barriers (visual + distance), shifted yard times, and the polite written note; you control your side only
He found the ONE unfilmed window	of course he did	film it; window barkers are auditors; the gym must be fully closed to stay closed
Calm indoors now, same outside numbers	give it time	the bucket effect lags ~2 weeks; keep the outdoor ladder running; check the log's trend, not the week

CASE LOG

Date	Phase	What we ran	Result (1-5)

CASE 07

Car Reactivity

A 70-MPH CRATE WITH WINDOWS · PAGE 1 OF 4 · THE PHYSICS

C7

WHY IT BREAKS THE NORMAL RULES

The car is three problems wearing one seatbelt: **loading** (a dog who fights the door), **riding** (whining, pacing, drooling the whole trip), and **window reactivity** (explosions at dogs and pedestrians through glass). They braid together because the car concentrates everything: tight space, no exits, triggers strafing past at speed, and a destination history that's mostly vets and groomers.

The car is also where the zone map seems broken — triggers pass at two feet! — until you notice the fix: control the WINDOW, not the world. A crate or covered side-glass is portable distance.

WHAT CHANGES VS THE STANDARD METHOD

Distance becomes **visual access**: a crate, a seat hammock, or clipped shades turn an exposed back seat into a den. And destinations need re-balancing: the car must stop meaning “probably the vet.”

Four-page treatment: physics → setup → the 3-phase protocol → mistakes & troubleshooting. Read all four before the first session; run them from page 3.

CASE 07

Car Reactivity

A 70-MPH CRATE WITH WINDOWS · PAGE 2 OF 4 · THE SETUP

C7

SETUP CHECKLIST — BEFORE THE FIRST SESSION

Hardware and history, before any drills:

- ✓ **Containment:** a crash-rated crate (best), a clipped harness + seat hammock (good). A loose reactive dog in a car is dangerous to everyone, calm or not.
- ✓ **Sight management:** crate cover or static-cling shade film on the rear side windows. He doesn't need the view; the view is the problem.
- ✓ **The destination ledger:** list the last 10 car trips. If 8 were vet/groomer, the car's reputation is earned — and fixable.
- ✓ Park where loading happens AWAY from street traffic if possible (driveway side, garage).
- ✓ Pack a **car kit:** lick-mat that velcros/suctions in the crate, water, and the boring towel that smells like home.
- ✓ Decide the rule: **no walks FROM the car** at trigger-rich destinations until Phase 3 — arrive, decompress, then work.

OUR LAST 10 TRIPS (HONEST LEDGER)

CONTAINMENT + SHADE SETUP CHOSEN

CASE 07

Car Reactivity

A 70-MPH CRATE WITH WINDOWS · PAGE 3 OF 4 · THE PROTOCOL

C7

THE THREE-PHASE PROTOCOL

PHASE 1 · THE PARKED CAR IS FURNITURE (DAYS 1-4)

5 MIN ×
2/DAY

1. Engine off, driveway: load up, lick-mat in the crate, sit in the front seat scrolling your phone, unload. That's the whole rep.
2. Day 3-4: engine ON, going nowhere. Same picnic.
3. Pay calm loading like it's a trick (it is): "YES" the moment paws commit to the car.

PHASE 2 · MICRO-TRIPS TO GOOD PLACES (DAYS 5-10)

1
TRIP/DAY

1. Three-minute drives that end somewhere great: the sniffari field, the drive-through that hands out pup cups, back home to dinner.
2. Shades ON, crate covered to half: the world is a soundtrack, not a slideshow.
3. The ledger flips: by day 10, recent history reads 8 good trips out of 10. The car's reputation follows its ledger.

PHASE 3 · WINDOWS & THE WORKING COMMUTE (WEEKS 2-3)

GRADUATED

1. Begin un-covering: half-shade at week 2. Passing dogs get the Phase-2 sound-game treatment (YES + treat through the crate door the instant he notices-without-barking) — passenger required; drivers drive.
2. Red lights next to dogs on sidewalks are the exam: if it's still hot, shades go back up for a week. The glass is your ladder; opacity is your distance.
3. Arrivals protocol forever: park, 2-minute settle with the lick-mat, THEN unload to a sniff-first start. No tailgate explosions.

CASE 07

Car Reactivity

A 70-MPH CRATE WITH WINDOWS · PAGE 4 OF 4 · THE PITFALLS

C7

THE CLASSIC MISTAKES

- ✗ Letting him ride loose “because he only barks sometimes” — a 60-lb projectile with opinions at 40mph.
- ✗ Window down for the joy of it — you've built a moving fence-line (see Case 6) with extra wind.
- ✗ Only driving to the vet, then wondering why the car is cursed — ledgers don't lie.
- ✗ Treating highway whining and trigger explosions as one problem — arousal-whine needs the Phase 1-2 den work; explosions need the glass ladder; diagnose before drilling.
- ✗ Feeding a big meal before the drive — nausea and reactivity stack; travel on a light stomach.

TROUBLESHOOTING

What's happening	What it usually is	What to do
Fights the loading door itself	loading = launch sequence for bad places	ten days of Phase 1 with zero actual trips; feed dinner IN the parked car twice
Screams only at dogs, only through HIS side window	positional habit (his patrol seat)	swap sides/crate position + film that pane first; habits have addresses
Drools/vomits every ride	motion sickness, not (only) behavior	vet conversation (real anti-nausea support exists); behavior work can't out-train an inner ear
Perfect in the crate, explosive the second it opens at arrival	threshold launch, car edition	the 2-minute settle + scatter OUT of the crate door before full exit; doorway rules (Case 2) on wheels

CASE LOG

Date	Phase	What we ran	Result (1-5)

CASE 08

The Doorbell & Visitors

TERRITORY PLUS SURPRISE, THE INDOOR DOUBLE · PAGE 1 OF 4 · THE PHYSICS

C8

WHY IT BREAKS THE NORMAL RULES

Leash reactivity happens to OTHER people's dogs and strangers; the doorbell happens to HIS house. Different system: territorial arousal, with the doorbell as a starting pistol that fires maybe twice a week — far too rarely to habituate on its own, exciting enough to rehearse perfectly every time. Add the hallway pile-up (humans crowding a threshold, shouting over barking, strangers reaching to pet 'to make friends') and you get the most reliably botched scenario in dog ownership.

The architecture of the fix: **separate the alarm from the entry**. The bell can mean something wonderful happens in the KITCHEN — while the door, decoupled, gets handled by boring adults.

△ WHAT CHANGES VS THE STANDARD METHOD

Safety first, always: if the concern is biting visitors rather than barking at them, this is a credentialed-professional case (FE safety page), not a workbook case. This protocol is for the barker-and-circler, not the biter.

Four-page treatment: physics → setup → the 3-phase protocol → mistakes & troubleshooting. Read all four before the first session; run them from page 3.

CASE 08

The Doorbell & Visitors

TERRITORY PLUS SURPRISE, THE INDOOR DOUBLE · PAGE 2 OF 4 · THE SETUP

C8

SETUP CHECKLIST — BEFORE THE FIRST SESSION

One prep evening, household meeting included:

- ✓ Pick the **bell station**: a mat in the kitchen, far from the door, where bell-magic will happen.
- ✓ Stock **station jackpots** by it: jar of high-grade treats + a frozen lick-mat in the freezer, always loaded.
- ✓ Install **the gate**: a baby gate or closed door between the dog's zone and the entry hall. Greetings happen across it or not at all.
- ✓ Brief the household script: ONE person handles the dog (station), another the door. Solo? Dog goes behind the gate FIRST, door second; guests can wait 45 seconds — really, they can.
- ✓ Brief your regular guests by text, in advance: “ignore the dog completely, no eye contact, no reaching, we'll release him when he's calm. He's in training.”
- ✓ Record your own doorbell on your phone (you'll need it at volume 2).

OUR BELL STATION & GATE PLACEMENT

THE HOUSEHOLD SCRIPT (WHO DOES WHAT)

CASE 08

The Doorbell & Visitors

TERRITORY PLUS SURPRISE, THE INDOOR DOUBLE · PAGE 3 OF 4 · THE PROTOCOL

C8

THE THREE-PHASE PROTOCOL

PHASE 1 · REWIRE THE BELL (DAYS 1-5)

10 REPS ×
2/DAY

1. No visitors. Play the recorded bell at low volume → immediately rain 5 treats on the bell station mat. Repeat.
2. He'll start sprinting to the STATION at the sound — that's the whole point. Raise volume over days until the real bell, rung by a family member, sends him stationward.
3. Bark happens? Volume down two notches. The game pays the run-to-station, not silence per se — silence comes along free.

PHASE 2 · THE STOOGES VISITS (DAYS 6-12)

2-3
VISITS

1. Recruit a patient friend. Bell → dog to station (handler pays) → stooge enters, sits down, IGNORES the dog completely, gate still closed.
2. Dog calm at the gate for 60 seconds (four feet on floor, mouth open)? Open the gate, leash ON, stooge keeps ignoring. Let the dog do the approaching; investigation without contact is a perfect outcome.
3. Stooge tosses one treat SIDEWAYS (not from the hand, not while staring) after 5 minutes of boring coexistence. Visit ends before the dog tires of succeeding.

PHASE 3 · REAL GUESTS, REAL LIFE (WEEK 3+)

EVERY
VISIT

1. The system becomes the house rule: bell → station → gate → calm → leashed release → guests ignore.
2. The lick-mat covers dinner parties: station + frozen mat = 20 minutes of self-managed calm; re-load as needed. He doesn't have to join every party; the gate-side nap is a win.
3. Delivery knocks (no entry): bell-game pays, nobody comes in, dog learns most alarms are blanks. The Amazon era is, for once, useful.

CASE 08

The Doorbell & Visitors

TERRITORY PLUS SURPRISE, THE INDOOR DOUBLE · PAGE 4 OF 4 · THE PITFALLS

C8

THE CLASSIC MISTAKES

- ✗ Guests “helping” with eye contact, baby talk, and outstretched hands — the fastest way to re-light a territorial dog; brief them or gate them.
- ✗ Punishing the bark at the bell — you've paired strangers-at-the-door with trouble, the exact wrong ledger.
- ✗ Holding the collar during entries — restraint + arousal at a threshold is lunge-manufacturing; that's what the gate is for.
- ✗ Skipping Phase 1 because the dog “knows the bell” — he does; that's the problem; the knowing must be rewritten, not assumed away.
- ✗ Testing with the pizza guy on day 3 — stooges are briefed and boring; delivery drivers are fast-moving strangers with hot bags. Week 3 material.

TROUBLESHOOTING

What's happening	What it usually is	What to do
Station works for the bell, collapses at the KNOCK	different sound, untrained	run Phase 1 again with recorded knocking; alarm sounds are itemized in dog brains
Calm until the guest stands up / moves rooms	motion re-triggers the alarm	guests announce-and-move slowly early on; handler pays station during transitions; it fades by visit 3
He won't leave the gate, just stares and whines	wants in, can't cope yet	extend gate-side phase with the lick-mat; some dogs need 5 visits before a calm release; the gate IS the success
Fine with adults, hard barking at kids	kids move and sound like nothing else	kid visits stay gated, full stop, and re-read the safety page — child-directed intensity is professional territory

CASE LOG

Date	Phase	What we ran	Result (1–5)

CASE 09

The Regression Week

WHEN THE GRAPH FALLS AND FAITH FOLLOWS · PAGE 1 OF 4 · THE PHYSICS

C9

WHY IT BREAKS THE NORMAL RULES

Somewhere around week four to seven, almost every owner running this method hits the same wall: the number climbs for days, the loops get sticky, and a voice whispers that it was all luck. Week-one Megan would have spiraled. You have logs — so this case is less about the dog and more about running an honest investigation instead of a panic.

Regression has a short cause-list (an under-logged incident, adolescence, season shifts, pain, or plain statistical waves), and a single universal treatment: drain, re-measure, rebuild the floor, re-ladder. The skill is doing it CALMLY, on schedule, like a mechanic — not like a heartbroken gambler doubling down.

★ WHAT CHANGES VS THE STANDARD METHOD

Nothing new to learn — this case is the method applied to its own bad week, plus the one diagnostic that outranks training: **sudden regression with ANY physical change is a vet visit first**. Pain is the great impersonator of bad behavior.

Four-page treatment: physics → setup → the 3-phase protocol → mistakes & troubleshooting. Read all four before the first session; run them from page 3.

CASE 09

The Regression Week

WHEN THE GRAPH FALLS AND FAITH FOLLOWS · PAGE 2 OF 4 · THE SETUP

C9

SETUP CHECKLIST — BEFORE THE FIRST SESSION

The investigation kit, before any retraining:

- ✓ Pull the **last 14 days of logs** and read them as a stranger would. Circle every bucket-event and every distance jump.
- ✓ Run the **incident audit**: ask the household what happened that nobody logged (the gate ambush, the off-leash 'friendly', the firework Tuesday).
- ✓ Run the **body audit**: appetite, stairs, jumping on the couch, being touched at the hips/ears. ANY 'hmm' = vet first, retrain second.
- ✓ Check the **calendar suspects**: adolescence window (6–18 months)? Season change? New schedule, new baby, new neighbor dog?
- ✓ Freeze the ladder: no descending work during the investigation. Maintenance only.
- ✓ Re-read your own day-21 letter. That's what it was for.

WHAT THE AUDIT FOUND (SUSPECTS, HONESTLY)

CASE 09

The Regression Week

WHEN THE GRAPH FALLS AND FAITH FOLLOWS · PAGE 3 OF 4 · THE PROTOCOL

C9

THE THREE-PHASE PROTOCOL

PHASE 1 · THE DRAIN (DAYS 1-2)

2 QUIET
DAYS

1. Two consecutive sniffari days, indoor enrichment evenings, zero training. Whatever the cause, the bucket is full; empty it first.
2. No diagnostics on these days either — you can't read a draining system.
3. Household briefing: this is a planned protocol, not a setback. Use those words at dinner.

PHASE 2 · RE-MEASURE & FLOOR (DAYS 3-6)

DAY-3 PROTOCOL

1. Formal re-measure, day-3 rules, in pen, no commentary. The new number is the number.
2. Three days of week-2-style anchor work AT that number: easy loops, generous pay, early quits. You're rebuilding the floor, not chasing the old high score.
3. Log normally. Watch the mouth scores — they recover before the distances do, and they'll tell you the floor is back.

PHASE 3 · THE RE-LADDER (WEEK 2)

3-FOR-3,
STANDARD

1. Resume the ladder exactly as day 15 wrote it. Expect to re-earn the lost cars in roughly a third of the original time — the wiring survives; it was the chemistry that wobbled.
2. Keep one insurance habit from this episode permanently: the weekly log-read. Two minutes of trend-reading catches the next wave at ankle height.
3. When the number returns: write one paragraph under the day-21 letter about what this wave was. Future-you collects these.

CASE 09

The Regression Week

WHEN THE GRAPH FALLS AND FAITH FOLLOWS · PAGE 4 OF 4 · THE PITFALLS

C9

THE CLASSIC MISTAKES

- ✗ Doubling session length to “fix it fast” — full-bucket marathons are how regressions metastasize.
- ✗ Skipping the vet check because “he seems fine” — limping is late-stage; appetite and touch-tolerance shift first.
- ✗ Re-running week 1 from scratch in despair — you are not at square one; the floor rebuild takes days, not weeks.
- ✗ Announcing “the method stopped working” to the household mid-wave — narratives stick; wait for the re-measure before issuing verdicts.
- ✗ Quitting the logs because they hurt to read — the logs are the way out; they're only depressing when read daily instead of weekly.

TROUBLESHOOTING

What's happening	What it usually is	What to do
Re-measure keeps bouncing day to day	still draining, or an active ongoing stressor	extend Phase 1; hunt the active drip (construction? new fence dog?) before trusting any number
Floor rebuilds, ladder stalls at one stubborn rung	a specific context got poisoned (one corner, one dog)	ladder around it: new locations for a week, then return to the haunted rung as if it were new
Regression #3 this season	pattern, not weather	book the professional consult WITH your logs; recurring waves deserve expert eyes (and arrive with great data)
I'm fine mechanically, but I've lost my nerve	handler-side regression, fully normal	week of Route-B-only wins, 5-minute sessions, and re-read the closing letter; handlers rebuild on the same ladder dogs do

CASE LOG

Date	Phase	What we ran	Result (1–5)

Your two cases, on paper

FROM TRIAGE — CASE A (THE DAILY ONE)

CASE A: SETUP ITEMS STILL MISSING (FROM ITS PAGE 2)

CASE A: PHASE 1 STARTS ON (DATE)

FROM TRIAGE — CASE B (THE SITUATIONAL ONE)

CASE B: SETUP ITEMS STILL MISSING

CASE B: PHASE 1 STARTS ON (DATE)

Week	Case A phase	Case B phase	Main-plan maintenance (3 walks + sniffari?)	Re-measure?

★ THE LOAD RULE

Hard cases ride ON TOP of maintenance, never instead of it. If a week can't fit both, maintenance wins and the case waits — a drained bucket is the precondition for every protocol in this book.

The street will keep writing new exams

And that's fine, because you stopped studying for exams somewhere around the middle of this book. You learned the physics instead: arousal is a budget, distance has substitutes, rehearsal is destiny, and every chaos on four legs yields to setup plus protocol plus an honest log.

Somewhere in your neighborhood there's an owner mid-spiral — 5am walks, gear drawer of regrets, a dog they love and dread. You can't hand them a method on a sidewalk. But you can be the person whose dog passes them at four cars, boring as furniture, while you nod like it's nothing. It isn't nothing. It's engineering.

Walk on.

— CalmWalk

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